

Jan Pfänder

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Positions

Swiss Federal Institute of Aquatic Science and Technology (Eawag) Zurich, Switzerland
 Postdoctoral researcher Jan 2025 – present
 • Advisor: Viktoria Cologna

Education

PhD **École Normale Supérieure (ENS-PSL), Institut Jean Nicod, Psychology** Paris, France
 • Supervisors: Hugo Mercier & Kevin Arceneaux 2022 – 2025
 • Thesis: Essays on Understanding Trust in Science

MA **École Normale Supérieure (ENS-PSL), Cognitive Science** Paris, France
 • Supervisor: Hugo Mercier 2020 – 2022
 • Thesis: Can we infer people are accurate and competent merely because they agree with each other?

MA **Universität Freiburg, Journalism (1st year)** Freiburg, Germany
 2019 – 2020

BA **Universität Konstanz, Political Science and Public Administration** Konstanz, Germany
 2014 – 2018

Work Experience

Direction Interministérielle de la Transformation Publique (DITP) Paris, France
 Research Intern Jun 2021 – Aug 2021

Assemblée Nationale Paris, France
 Parliamentary Assistant Sep 2018 – Jul 2019

University of St. Gallen St. Gallen, Switzerland
 Research Assistant Jun 2017 – Jul 2018

Publications

Peer-reviewed publications
 (n = 5)

Global studies on trust in science suggest new theoretical and methodological directions 2026
 J. Pfänder, N. G. Mede, V. Cologna
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.copsy.2025.102215> (Current Opinion in Psychology)

Trusting but forgetting impressive science 2025
 J. Pfänder, S. de Rouilhan, H. Mercier
<https://doi.org/10.1163/15685373-12340227> (Journal of Cognition and Culture)

Quasi-universal acceptance of basic science in the United States 2025
 J. Pfänder, L. Kerzreh, H. Mercier
<https://doi.org/10.1177/09636625251364407> (Public Understanding of Science)

Spotting false news and doubting true news: a systematic review and meta-analysis of news judgements 2025
 J. Pfänder, S. Altay
<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-024-02086-1> (Nature Human Behaviour)

How wise is the crowd: Can we infer people are accurate and competent merely because they agree with each other? 2025
 J. Pfänder, B. de Courson, H. Mercier
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cognition.2024.106005> (Cognition)

Conference proceedings

(n = 1)

How wise is the crowd: Can we infer people are accurate and competent merely because they agree with each other? 2024

J. Pfänder, B. de Courson, H. Mercier

escholarship.org/uc/item/4ms2n8wd (Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society)

Large collaborations (minor role)

(n = 2)

Trust in scientists and their role in society across 68 countries 2025

V. Cologna, N. G. Mede, S. Berger, ..., J. Pfänder, ... et al.

<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-024-02090-5> (Nature Human Behaviour)

Perceptions of science, science communication, and climate change attitudes in 68 countries – the TISP dataset 2025

N. G. Mede, V. Cologna, S. Berger, ..., J. Pfänder, ... et al.

<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41597-024-04100-7> (Scientific Data)

Working papers

(n = 2)

The rational impression account of trust in science 2025

J. Pfänder, H. Mercier

https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/nwka2_v1

The French trust more the sciences they perceive as precise and consensual 2025

J. Pfänder, H. Mercier

https://doi.org/10.31219/osf.io/k9m6e_v1

Presentations

Invited talks

Trust in science 2025

Paris School of International Affairs (Sciences Po), Paris

Conference presentations

Belief in & interventions against misinformation 2025

15th Annual Conference of the European Political Science Association, Madrid

The rational impression account of trust in science 2025

Explaining culture: an interdisciplinary approach, Paris

Spotting False News and Doubting True News. A Meta-Analysis of News Judgments (Keynote) 2025

Infox sur Seine, Paris

How wise is the crowd: Can we infer people are accurate and competent merely because they agree with each other? (Poster) 2024

46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Rotterdam

Processus sous-tendant la confiance dans la science 2024

5ème édition des Rencontres Jeunes Chercheur·euse·s, Grenoble

Spotting False News and Doubting True News: A Meta-Analysis of News Judgments 2024

EDMO Scientific Conference on Disinformation, Amsterdam

Teaching

Courses

Fact-Checking and Critical Thinking 2022 – 2025

Université PSL (Paris Sciences & Lettres) – BA program "Sciences pour un monde durable"

- A hands-on introduction to research design for an interdisciplinary BA program
- Sole instructor & creator of the course
- 30h in-class per semester; one semester a year

Workshops

Meta-analysis for beginners

2024

Laboratoire de Psychologie du Développement et de l'Éducation de l'Enfant (LaPsyDÉ)

Advising

Graduate students

- Lou Kerzreho (2023)

Undergraduate students

- Mateo Pivert (2024)
- Ludivine Million (2024)
- Prune Lefevre Jachimowicz (2024)
- Kevin Chen (2023)
- Théodore Lellouche (2022)

Professional Service

Peer Reviewing

($n = 10$)

- Journals: *Nature Climate Change* (1), *Public Understanding of Science* (3), *PNAS Nexus* (1), *Social Science & Medicine* (1), *Društvena istraživanja* (1), *Behavior Research Methods* (1), *Educational Research Review* (1), *Artificial Intelligence Review* (1)

Summer Schools

Diverse Intelligences Summer Institute

St. Andrews, UK

Hosted by the University of St. Andrews, organized by Indiana University Bloomington

2024

Skills

Languages: German, English, French, Spanish

Programming: R, Git (basics), Python (rudimentary)